

CENTRAL BOARD OF SECONDARY EDUCATION

SAMPLE QUESTION PAPER

Academic Session: 2026–27

Class: 10

Subject: Social Science (SST)

Maximum Marks: 50

Time Allowed: 2 Hours

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS

- **The question paper has 5 sections: A, B, C, D, and E.**
- Section A has 12 Multiple Choice Questions (MCQs) of 1 mark each.
- Section B has 3 Very Short Answer (VSA) questions of 2 marks each.
- Section C has 3 Short Answer (SA) questions of 3 marks each.
- Section D has 2 Long Answer (LA) questions of 5 marks each.
- Section E has 2 Case Study Based Questions of 4 marks each.
- All questions are compulsory. However, an internal choice is provided in some questions.
- There is no overall choice.
- Draw neat and clean diagrams wherever required.

SECTION A

Multiple Choice Questions

Q1. Which of the following treaties recognized Greece as an independent nation?

(A) Treaty of Versailles

(B) Treaty of Vienna

(C) Treaty of Constantinople

(D) Treaty of Frankfurt

(1 Mark)

Q2. Which of the following is a key feature of a federal system of government?

(A) One level of government

(B) Power concentrated in a single authority

(C) Division of power between different levels of government

(D) Absence of an independent judiciary

(1 Mark)

Q3. Identify the primary sector activity from the options below.

(A) Banking

(B) Manufacturing cars

(C) Fishing

(D) Teaching

(1 Mark)

Q4. Which of the following resources is non-renewable?

(A) Solar energy

(B) Wind energy

(C) Coal

(D) Water

(1 Mark)

Q5. Which of the following crops is a major source of food and fodder?

(A) Cotton

(B) Jute

(C) Maize

(D) Tea

(1 Mark)

Q6. Who among the following was the founder of the 'Young Italy' secret society?

(A) Otto von Bismarck

(B) Giuseppe Mazzini

(C) Klemens von Metternich

(D) Giuseppe Garibaldi

(1 Mark)

Q7. Which of the following is a characteristic of a democratic government?

- (A) Rule by a single party
- (B) Hereditary succession
- (C) Accountability to the citizens
- (D) Suppression of dissent

(1 Mark)

Q8. What is the main objective of the World Trade Organization (WTO)?

- (A) To promote cultural exchange
- (B) To facilitate international trade
- (C) To resolve political disputes
- (D) To provide humanitarian aid

(1 Mark)

Q9. Which of the following dams is built on the river Satluj?

- (A) Hirakud Dam
- (B) Bhakra Nangal Dam
- (C) Sardar Sarovar Dam

(D) Tehri Dam

(1 Mark)

Q10. Which of the following is an example of a push factor for migration?

(A) Better job opportunities

(B) Higher wages

(C) Political instability

(D) Access to better education

(1 Mark)

Q11. The process of rapid integration or interconnection between countries is known as:

(A) Privatization

(B) Liberalization

(C) Globalization

(D) Nationalization

(1 Mark)

Q12. Which of the following is a major challenge to democracy?

(A) Economic equality

(B) Social harmony

(C) Corruption

(D) Political stability

(1 Mark)

SECTION B

Very Short Answer Questions

Q13. Explain the concept of 'resource planning'.

(2 Marks)

Q14. Differentiate between a unitary and a federal system of government.

(2 Marks)

Q15. State any two ways in which multinational corporations (MNCs) control production across countries.

(2 Marks)

SECTION C

Short Answer Questions

Q16. How did the Balkan region become a source of nationalist tension in Europe after 1871? Explain with examples.

(3 Marks)

Q17. "Water scarcity in most cases is caused by over-exploitation, excessive use and unequal access to water among different social groups." Justify the statement.

(3 Marks)

Q18. Explain the importance of the tertiary sector in the Indian economy.

(3 Marks)

OR

Describe any three ways in which credit can be helpful for people.

(3 Marks)

SECTION D

Long Answer Questions

Q19. Describe the role of women in the nationalist struggles of Europe.

(5 Marks)

OR

Explain the causes and consequences of the Great Depression of 1929.

(5 Marks)

Q20. Discuss the various challenges faced by political parties in a democracy. Suggest ways to overcome these challenges.

(5 Marks)

OR

"Democracy stands much superior to any other form of government in promoting dignity and freedom of the individual." Justify the statement with five arguments.

(5 Marks)

SECTION E

Case Study

Q21. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow:

The Constitution of India provides for a three-fold distribution of legislative powers between the Union Government and the State Governments. It contains three lists:

1. Union List: It includes subjects of national importance such as defence, foreign affairs, banking, communications and currency. The Union Government alone can make laws relating to these subjects.
2. State List: It contains subjects of State and local importance such as police, trade, commerce, agriculture and irrigation. The State Governments alone can make laws relating to these subjects.
3. Concurrent List: It includes subjects of common interest to both the Union Government as well as the State Governments, such as education, forest, trade unions, marriage, adoption and succession. Both the Union as well as the State Governments can make laws on these subjects. If their laws conflict with each other, the law made by the Union Government will prevail.

Q21.1. Which list includes subjects of national importance?

(1 Mark)

Q21.2. Give an example of a subject from the State List.

(1 Mark)

Q21.3. What happens if there is a conflict between a law made by the Union Government and a law made by a State Government on a subject in the Concurrent List?

(2 Marks)

Q22. Read the source given below and answer the questions that follow:

The idea of power-sharing has emerged in opposition to the notions of undivided political power. For a long time, it was believed that all power of a government must reside in one person or group of persons located at one place. It was felt that if the power to decide is dispersed, it would not be possible to take quick decisions and to enforce them. But these notions have changed with the emergence of democracies. One basic principle of democracy is that people are the source of all political power. In a democracy, people rule themselves through institutions of self-governance. In a good democratic government, due respect is given to diverse groups and views that exist in a society. Everyone has a voice in the shaping of public policies. Therefore, it follows that a democratic government involves power-sharing with those affected by its exercise, and who have to live with its effects.

Q22.1. What was the traditional belief about political power?

(1 Mark)

Q22.2. According to the text, what is the basic principle of democracy regarding political power?

(1 Mark)

Q22.3. How does a good democratic government ensure power-sharing?

(2 Marks)

End of Question Paper